

Third Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Tertia Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: humility, vigilance, and the shepherd's joy

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Fathers and saints	Connection
Introit	<i>Respice in me, et miserere mei</i> (Ps. 24)	Poverty before God	St. Augustine, Enarrationes in Psalmos; St. Francis of Assisi	The soul begins as solitary and poor, but poverty becomes the place where mercy is seen.
Collect	God as protector; temporal goods passed through toward eternal goods	Pilgrimage and right use	St. Gregory of Nyssa on ascent; St. Augustine, City of God XIX	Temporal goods are not despised but traversed under God's rule.
Epistle	1 Pet. 5:6-11	Humility under God's hand; vigilance against the devil	St. Leo the Great on humility; St. Anthony and desert vigilance	The Christian resists not by self-trust but by sober humility and faith.
Gospel	Luke 15:1-10	Lost sheep and lost drachma	St. Ambrose on Luke; St. Gregory the Great on pastoral care	The murmuring of the righteous is answered by heaven's joy over repentance.
Offertory	<i>Sperant in te omnes</i> (Ps. 9)	Trust of the poor	St. Basil on care for the poor	The poor are not forgotten; the offering becomes their prayer in the Church.
Communion	<i>Gaudium est Angelis Dei</i> (Luke 15:10)	Angelic joy over one sinner	St. Bernard on conversion; St. Therese of Lisieux on confidence	Communion is not a prize for the never-lost but the feast of being found.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Luke 15 recounts Christ receiving sinners and answering murmurers with the lost sheep and lost drachma; 1 Peter exhorts humility, vigilance, and trust.
Allegorical	The shepherd is Christ bearing fallen humanity home on his shoulders, and the woman searching the house images the Church seeking the lost by the light of grace.
Moral	The sinner must let himself be found through humility and repentance, while the devout must renounce murmuring and rejoice at another's return.
Anagogical	The Communion antiphon points to heavenly joy: one repentant sinner on earth becomes the occasion of angelic gladness in heaven.

Homily Sketch

Proposition. The Christian life is not self-rescue. Humility lets itself be found, carried, restored, and made the cause of joy in heaven.

Opening movement. The Introit speaks as one poor and alone: *unicus et pauper sum ego*. The Gospel answers that loneliness with a shepherd who notices one missing sheep and a woman who searches for one lost coin.

Doctrinal center. The Epistle gives the interior posture of the found sinner: humility under God's mighty hand, sobriety, vigilance, and resistance in faith. Grace does not make vigilance unnecessary; it makes vigilance hopeful.

Moral turn. The murmuring Pharisee is the danger inside the devout soul. He can be near religion and far from the joy of God.

Exegetical Notes

- Luke 15 begins with publicans and sinners drawing near. The first movement belongs to grace: sinners are attracted to Christ.
- The lost sheep is not lectured back; it is carried. This supports a homily on confession, absolution, and pastoral patience.
- The Epistle's devil imagery is not theatrical. Pride isolates; isolation makes the soul easier to devour.

Witness	Short text	Homiletic use
St. Gregory the Great	The shepherd places the sheep on his shoulders.	Preach Christ's Passion as the shoulders on which the sinner is borne home.
St. Ambrose	The sheep is wearied, not despised.	Use this to distinguish contrition from self-hatred.
St. Peter	"Casting all your care upon him." 1 Pet. 5:7	Let the scriptural phrase become the invitation to confession and trust.
St. Therese of Lisieux	Confidence and love are her way to God.	Connect childlike confidence with being carried by the Shepherd.

Thread	Synthesis
Humility and mercy	Peter's command to humble ourselves prepares us to be found. The sheep is carried because it cannot restore itself.
Vigilance and joy	The devil hunts by isolation and despair; the Gospel answers with a shepherd who searches and a heaven that rejoices.
Murmuring and mission	The Pharisee asks why Christ receives sinners; the Church must answer by becoming the place where repentant sinners are actually received.
Poverty and praise	The Introit's poor man becomes the Communion's cause of angelic joy. Poverty under mercy turns into doxology.
Prayer focus	Replace anxious self-repair with a concrete act of humble confession and renewed trust in the Shepherd.

Preaching Applications

- Speak directly to shame: the Gospel does not minimize sin, but it puts the initiative of mercy first.
- Warn the devout against joyless correctness when another sinner returns.
- Invite confession as the practical enactment of being found and carried.

Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Tertia post Pentecosten*.
- Suggested patristic study: Ambrose on Luke 15; Gregory the Great, Pastoral Rule; Augustine on Psalm 24.